

AJAY PINGALI

Senior Java Developer | AWS Certified Solutions Architect | Microservices | Kafka | Full Stack

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Senior Java Developer with about 5 years of hands-on experience, mostly in backend systems - microservices, REST APIs, Kafka pipelines, and AWS infrastructure. I've spent the last couple of years working at Optum Health and DoorDash, which gave me real exposure to what it means to build and maintain systems at scale in regulated and high-throughput environments. My core stack is Java 17/21, Spring Boot 3.x, Kafka, and AWS, but I'm comfortable across the full delivery cycle - from writing APIs and setting up CI/CD to deploying in Kubernetes and building Angular or React dashboards. I hold an AWS Solutions Architect certification, use GitHub Copilot day to day, and have been getting into Spring AI on the side. I work well in Agile teams, take code quality seriously, and am looking for roles – contract or full-time – where I can contribute from day one and make a genuine impact. Open to C2C and full-time opportunities, remote or hybrid.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Java 8/11/17/21 (Virtual Threads / Project Loom) | Spring Boot 3.x | Microservices Architecture | REST API Design | GraphQL | Apache Kafka | Event-Driven Architecture
AWS (Certified) | Azure (Familiar) | Docker | Kubernetes | Terraform | GitHub Actions | Jenkins | CI/CD | Spring Security | OAuth2 | JWT | HIPAA Compliance | RBAC
PostgreSQL | MySQL | Oracle | DynamoDB | Redis / ElastiCache | MongoDB | Apache Spark | Angular 8-19 | React JS | Vue.js | TypeScript | Full Stack
JUnit 5 | Mockito | SonarQube | OpenTelemetry | Swagger/OpenAPI | Agile/Scrum | TDD | BDD | GitHub Copilot | Spring AI (Emerging) | Quarkus (Familiar)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages	Java 8/11/17/21 (Project Loom, Virtual Threads, Records, Sealed Classes), Kotlin, Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, PL/SQL
Frameworks	Spring Boot 3.x, Spring MVC, Spring Security, Spring Cloud, Spring Data JPA, Spring Batch, Spring Integration, Spring AI (emerging), Hibernate, Apache Camel, JAX-RS, JAX-WS, JMS, JDBC, Quarkus (familiar), LangChain4j (familiar)
Cloud & AWS	EC2, S3, RDS, Aurora, DynamoDB, Lambda, API Gateway, IAM, Cognito, CloudWatch, CloudTrail, VPC, Route 53, SNS, SQS, Elastic Beanstalk, Auto Scaling, ELB, CloudFormation, CodePipeline, Step Functions, OpenSearch, ElastiCache
Azure (Familiar)	Azure App Services, Azure DevOps, Azure Functions, Azure Service Bus, AKS, Azure API Management (actively developing)
DevOps & IaC	Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Docker, Kubernetes (EKS/AKS), Terraform, CloudFormation, Ansible, Git, GitHub, Bitbucket, Maven, Gradle, Linux/Unix
Messaging & Data	Apache Kafka, Kafka Streams, RabbitMQ, SQS/SNS, Apache Spark, ETL Pipelines, Real-Time Streaming, Batch Processing
Databases	Oracle 12c, PostgreSQL, MySQL, SQL Server, MongoDB, DynamoDB, Redis, Cassandra, Liquibase, Flyway
Frontend	Angular (8/10/12/14/19), React JS, Vue.js, HTML5, CSS3, Bootstrap, TypeScript, RxJS, jQuery

Security & APIs	REST, SOAP, GraphQL, OAuth2, JWT, SAML, RBAC, HTTPS/TLS, Swagger/OpenAPI, Postman, WireMock
Testing & Quality	JUnit 5, Mockito, TestNG, Selenium, JMeter, SonarQube, Cucumber (BDD), WireMock
Observability	OpenTelemetry, ELK Stack, Kibana, Splunk, Datadog, Sumo Logic, Grafana, CloudWatch, Log4j, Distributed Tracing
AI & Dev Tools	GitHub Copilot, Spring AI, OpenAI API (familiar), LangChain4j (familiar)
Methodologies	Agile/Scrum, TDD, BDD, Code Reviews, Sprint Planning, Backlog Grooming, Production Support

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Java Developer

Jan 2025 – Present

Optum Health (UnitedHealth Group) | Eden Prairie, MN

Optum Health is one of the largest healthcare organizations in the US, serving over 100 million people. Working on backend services that handle member data exchange across clinical and operational systems - HIPAA-regulated environment, enterprise scale, and high stakes when something breaks.

- Built 12 Spring Boot 3.x microservices as part of a larger effort to break down a monolithic platform - made releases cleaner and reduced the blast radius when things go wrong. Team went from deploying bi-weekly to deploying on demand.
- Experimented with Java 21 virtual threads on a couple of high-concurrency services - reduced thread-blocking latency noticeably compared to the old thread-per-request setup.
- Wrote and maintained around 40 REST endpoints and a handful of GraphQL queries feeding internal dashboards - kept everything versioned and documented in Swagger, with HIPAA data handling built in from the start.
- Spent a good amount of time on query tuning - Oracle and MySQL, worked through execution plans on about 15 slow service calls and got average response time down by 38%.
- Set up Terraform modules for infrastructure provisioning - cut environment setup time by around 65% and made it repeatable across dev, QA, and prod without manual steps.
- Kafka handles async event traffic - roughly 80,000 events a day across healthcare workflows. Decoupling the downstream consumers from synchronous calls made the system noticeably more resilient under load.
- Got GitHub Actions into the CI pipeline alongside Jenkins - easier to maintain, reduced pipeline overhead, and the team no longer needs DevOps support for routine pipeline changes.
- Added OpenTelemetry instrumentation across core services - finally had proper distributed tracing instead of hunting through separate log streams during incidents. MTTR dropped by about 42%.
- Pushed unit test coverage from 61% to 91% using JUnit 5 and Mockito. SonarQube runs on every build.
- Built Angular dashboards and a couple of Vue.js screens for internal reporting - support staff said it cut their manual lookup time by around 25%.
- Using GitHub Copilot every day - mostly for boilerplate, test scaffolding, and documentation. It's made a real difference on the repetitive parts of the work.
- Managed schema migrations through Liquibase - stopped environment-mismatch bugs from slipping into releases.
- Mentored 3 junior developers - walked them through service design, deployment process, and what HIPAA-aware development actually means in practice.

Technologies: Java 17/21, Spring Boot 3.x, Spring Security, REST, GraphQL, JWT, OAuth2, AWS (EC2, S3, Lambda, API Gateway, IAM, Cognito, CloudWatch, ElastiCache, OpenSearch), Terraform, CloudFormation, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Docker, Kubernetes (EKS), Kafka, Oracle, MySQL, DynamoDB, Angular, Vue.js, JUnit 5, Mockito, SonarQube, OpenTelemetry, Splunk, Kibana, Liquibase, GitHub Copilot

Java Developer

Jun 2023 - Dec 2024

DoorDash | San Francisco, CA (Remote)

DoorDash runs at a pace where a slow API or a bad deployment affects real customers immediately - good environment for learning what production reliability actually means. Worked on backend services covering order processing, merchant integrations, and internal operational tooling.

- Owned and maintained 15 Spring Boot services covering the order lifecycle - cart, checkout, status updates, merchant data, and payouts. At peak, these APIs were handling over 300,000 daily requests with response times consistently under 200ms.
- Added Redis caching via AWS ElastiCache on six endpoints that were hammering the database on every call - brought database load down 42% and response times down 35% on those paths.
- Exposed merchant analytics through GraphQL so internal dashboard teams could query what they needed without us building separate API versions for every use case.
- Built a few React-based internal tools on the operational side - an exception management screen and a merchant status tracker that the ops team uses every day.
- Kafka and RabbitMQ handled async communication between eight services - SQS/SNS covered notifications and background processing. Removing those synchronous dependencies made the platform a lot more fault-tolerant during traffic spikes.
- Wrote Spark batch jobs and Python scripts to process 500,000+ transaction records nightly for merchant payout reconciliation - replaced a manual process that had been a recurring source of errors.
- Worked through 12 slow queries on PostgreSQL and MySQL - execution plans, index work, join restructuring. Average query time on critical order-tracking endpoints came down 45%.
- Moved some pipeline stages from Jenkins to GitHub Actions - build times came down about 20% and developers could manage pipelines without needing DevOps support.
- Used AWS Step Functions for multi-step order validation and payout workflows - cleaner than managing that state inside application code and much easier to monitor end to end.
- Managed DB migrations with Flyway - environment-mismatch bugs basically stopped happening once schema changes were version-controlled.
- Brought deployment cycle time from over 2 hours down to 25 minutes through parallelized builds and smarter test staging in the pipeline.
- Improved test coverage from 62% to 88% - production bug escape rate dropped by about 28% over two quarters.
- Handled 30+ production incidents over the engagement - monitored through CloudWatch, structured logging, and OpenTelemetry tracing. Maintained 99.9% uptime across order processing services throughout.

Technologies: Java 11, Spring Boot, Spring Security, REST, GraphQL, OAuth2, JWT, AWS (RDS, DynamoDB, SQS, SNS, CloudWatch, ElastiCache, Step Functions), Kafka, RabbitMQ, Redis, Python, Apache Spark, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Docker, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, React JS, Angular, JUnit 5, Mockito, OpenTelemetry, Flyway, GitHub Copilot, Git

Software Engineer

Jan 2021 - Dec 2022

Nitha Software Solutions | Hyderabad, India

Nitha Software Solutions is a mid-sized IT services firm building banking and operations software for regional financial clients. My first job - good place to build a foundation, learn how production systems actually work, and get comfortable with the full development cycle.

- Developed 6 backend modules in Java/Spring MVC for internal banking workflows - form processing, validations, transactional data - used daily by 150+ staff.
- Wrote REST services that fed reporting tools and internal applications - around 5,000 requests a day, stable throughout the engagement.
- Fixed 8 slow SQL reports in Oracle and MySQL after going through the query structure - generation time dropped about 40% and the business team noticed right away.
- Did front-end work in HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and jQuery across four internal tools - screen improvements that reduced support tickets related to navigation and usability.
- Tracked down and resolved 50+ defects in QA and production using Log4j logs - recurring defect rate dropped around 25% in the back half of my time there.
- Went through sprint cycles, code reviews, and design walkthroughs - got comfortable making changes carefully in a system real people depended on every day.

Technologies: Java 8, Spring MVC, JDBC, REST, Oracle, MySQL, SQL, PL/SQL, HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, jQuery, Log4j, Git, Agile/Scrum

EDUCATION

Master of Science - Information Technology & Management

May 2024

Concordia University, St. Paul | St. Paul, MN

Bachelor of Technology - Electrical & Electronics Engineering

May 2022

DVR & Dr. HS MIC College of Technology | India

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate

Amazon Web Services

Verified on Credly: [AWS Certificate](#)

Microsoft Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900)

Microsoft

In Progress - Expected Q3 2026